

Yameng Fan

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Education

2021 - present	Ph.D. in Economics , University of Hong Kong, Hong Kong
2018 - 2021	M.S. in Economics , Beijing Normal University, China
2014 - 2018	B.S. in Economics , Beijing Normal University, China
2017 - 2018	Exchange student , CUNEF University, Spain

Research Interests

Macro Development, Urban, Trade, Chinese Economy

Supervisors

Professor Xiaodong Zhu (xdzhu@hku.hk)
Professor Betty Xiao Wang (bxwang@hku.hk)

Awards

- Postgraduate Scholarship, University of Hong Kong, 2021-2025
- FBE PhD Entrance Scholarship, University of Hong Kong, 2021
- Jingshi Scholarship, Beijing Normal University, 2014-2021
- Maxdo Scholarship, Beijing Normal University, 2018

Working Paper

- "A Market Solution to Food Security: Evidence from a Policy Experiment in China"

Abstract: Food-security concerns often motivate land-use regulations that preserve farmland but restrict urban expansion and labor reallocation. This paper studies the Chongqing Land Coupon Reform, a market-based policy in China that allows rural construction land reclaimed as farmland to generate tradable land coupons, which developers can use to convert peri-urban farmland into urban construction land while maintaining aggregate farmland. Using comprehensive transaction-level data, I document that coupon supply comes primarily from remote rural counties, while demand is concentrated in urban fringe counties. Counties with lower initial agricultural value added per worker supply more coupons and experience higher rural-to-urban migration, and coupon-purchasing counties experience faster grain-yield growth. To quantify the aggregate effects, I develop a quantitative spatial model with heterogeneous agricultural productivity, endogenous migration, regulated land conversion, and a land coupon market. The framework shows how market-based land reallocation can mitigate the distortions

created by food-security-driven land regulations.

Presentation: World Bank Land Conference 2024, HKU Applied Study Group 2025, HKUST-UW Workshop 2026

Teaching Experience

- Selected Topics in Macroeconomics II (Postgraduate), Teaching Assistant, HKU, 2024
- Topics in Growth and Development (Postgraduate), Teaching Assistant, HKU, 2023
- Economic Globalization (Undergraduate), Teaching Assistant, BNU, 2020

Others

- Co-organizer of HKU International Economics Study Group
- Programming skills: Stata, Matlab, Arcgis, Python
- Language: Chinese(native), English(fluent), Spanish(intermediate)